



A FREE RESOURCE FROM ASOVIX

11 Hiring Leaders. 11 Hiring Insights.

Lessons from recruiters, HR leaders and hiring
managers across Ireland — drawn directly from 26
customer discovery interviews.

Morgan McKinley CPL Healthcare Noel Recruitment Teamwork.com
Ryanair Labs Capaciteam Cork Airport MTU

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HOW THIS GUIDE CAME TO BE

Nothing here was invented. Every line came from a real conversation.

Before Asovix built anything, we sat down with the people who actually make hiring decisions: recruiters, HR leaders, hiring managers and careers advisers at organisations across Ireland — including Morgan McKinley, CPL Healthcare, Noel Recruitment, Teamwork.com, Ryanair Labs, Capaciteam, Cork Airport and MTU. We asked them one question, in different ways, over and over: **what actually gets someone shortlisted?**

The answers were remarkably consistent — and remarkably different from what most job-seeking advice tells you. This guide collects eleven of those answers, one per page, translated into something you can act on today.

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NAMED ORGANISATIONS

How to use this guide

Each page has four parts: the **Recruiter Insight** — the real quote — the **pattern they see** in every hiring round, a plain-English translation under **What This Means**, and **Try This Today**, one small, specific action. Don't try to apply all eleven at once. Pick two and start there.



Morgan McKinley

Senior Recruitment Manager

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“The CV gets you the interview, but you are the only person who will actually get the job.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Candidates recite job titles and dates instead of telling their CV as a story
- Generic soft skills like “teamwork” and “communication” are listed with no evidence behind them
- Most are unprepared for competency-based (STAR) interview questions, especially around challenges overcome

WHAT THIS MEANS

A polished CV only earns you the interview. The recruiter's real filter happens in the room — can you talk through your own experience as a narrative, not a list of employers and dates?

TRY THIS TODAY

Pick three CV bullets and rehearse saying each one out loud, in full sentences, the way you'd explain it to a stranger. If it doesn't sound natural spoken, it isn't ready for an interview.





Healthcare Staffing & Training Leader

25-year nursing veteran, agency & temp staffing manager

RECRUITER INSIGHT

"The skill set you sell, that's the product... your customer is your employer."

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Recruiters read interview lateness as a direct signal you'll be late to work
- New hires show poor resilience when real-world practice differs from classroom theory
- Salary expectations are frequently out of step with actual market-value skill set

WHAT THIS MEANS

Employment is a transaction. You're not asking for a favour — you're selling a specific, named skill set to a buyer who has to justify the purchase internally. Candidates who think this way position themselves like professionals, not applicants.

TRY THIS TODAY

Write the one skill set you're actually selling for your target role in a single sentence, the way you'd pitch it to a buyer — not a list of duties, a value proposition.





B2B Sales & Hiring Leader

Regional Sales Manager

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Communication and soft skills often determine who gets hired.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Candidates misunderstand how recruitment actually works and contact the wrong recruiters entirely

WHAT THIS MEANS

Once you're through the CV filter, the deciding factor usually isn't another certification — it's whether you communicate clearly and know who you're actually talking to.

TRY THIS TODAY

Before reaching out to any recruiter, check whether they actually recruit for your sector and level — a five-minute LinkedIn check saves a wasted introduction.





Noel Recruitment

Recruitment Consultant

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Communication, responsiveness, networking, and cultural fit often matter just as much as qualifications and technical ability.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Fragmented CVs that don't hold together as one coherent story
- Slow or missing follow-up after recruiter contact
- Generic outreach that isn't personalised to the recruiter or role

WHAT THIS MEANS

Recruiters remember how reliable you were to work with, not just what's on the page. Responsiveness and personalisation are treated as a preview of how you'll behave as an employee.

TRY THIS TODAY

Reply to every recruiter message within 24 hours this week — and reference something specific from their message when you do.





University Careers & Employability Service

Careers Advisor / Employability Specialist

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Many students and graduates already possess valuable skills, but lack the confidence and communication ability to recognise, articulate, and present those skills effectively to employers.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Students underestimate their own abilities and existing experience
- Struggle to translate a job description into what it's actually asking for
- Fail to recognise which of their experiences are transferable

WHAT THIS MEANS

The skills gap most graduates worry about usually isn't real — it's an articulation gap. The experience is already there; it just hasn't been named in language an employer recognises.

TRY THIS TODAY

List five things from your final-year project or last job that required judgment, not just instructions — then check how many are actually on your CV.





MTU

Careers Advisor

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Students often believe their degree alone will secure employment, but employers consistently value transferable skills — communication, teamwork, adaptability, resilience, and critical thinking.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Students don't know how to tailor a CV to a specific job description
- Many leave applications too late and miss graduate deadlines
- Most are unaware of resources like Careers Connect, GradIreland or alumni networks

WHAT THIS MEANS

A degree proves you can learn. What gets you hired is proof you can apply skills like problem-solving and teamwork in a real work context — and most students never make that translation explicit.

TRY THIS TODAY

For one module or project on your CV, add a line connecting it to a transferable skill an employer would recognise — “group project” becomes “cross-functional delivery under deadline.”





CPL Healthcare

Principal Executive, Social Care Recruitment

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Employers are not simply hiring candidates with the right qualifications. They are hiring people who demonstrate professionalism, communication, adaptability, emotional intelligence, teamwork, and cultural fit.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Candidates struggle to build rapport and communicate confidently through the process
- Professionalism is judged on reliability and attitude, not just qualifications
- Long-term success is judged on workplace behaviour, not just getting hired

WHAT THIS MEANS

Getting hired and thriving in the role are two different tests — and employers are quietly screening for both at once, from your first interaction onward.

TRY THIS TODAY

Prepare one specific story that shows you adapting to a change in process or team — not a hypothetical, something that actually happened.





Teamwork.com

HR Business Partner & Recruiter

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“You can't see that in the CV, not really.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- A single role can attract a thousand applications, filtered by AI tools against criteria never listed in the job posting
- Candidates apply without researching the company at all — “who are you, what do you do?”
- Some misrepresent their location eligibility outright, which is checked and disqualifies them

WHAT THIS MEANS

At high-volume employers, you're being filtered by unwritten standards before a human ever reads your CV. The things that actually decide the outcome — attitude, motivation, genuine interest — are invisible on paper, so you have to surface them elsewhere.

TRY THIS TODAY

Before applying, spend ten minutes on the company's own careers page and recent posts — then use one specific detail in your application or opening message.





Ryanair Labs

Recruitment Manager

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Nobody wants to just read another plain CV.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Not researching the company before interview is treated as an automatic rejection: “did you not check LinkedIn? That’s a no.”
- Claiming broad, all-round skill sets (“I can do it all”) is read as a red flag, not a strength
- In-house recruiters have to manually cross-reference LinkedIn just to understand your previous employer’s context and scale

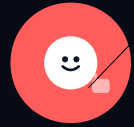
WHAT THIS MEANS

Generic self-description costs you credibility. Recruiters want specific, checkable claims about scale and context — not a claim you can do everything.

TRY THIS TODAY

Rewrite one CV line to name the actual scale of what you worked on — team size, user numbers, budget — instead of a general skill claim.





Capaciteam

CEO & Founder

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“They've listed a particular technology on their CV, and you ask them about it, and they haven't got a clue about it. That immediately is a massive red flag.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- AI-generated CVs are flooding inboxes and can't be authenticated in screening calls
- Candidates apply to unrelated roles with the same unchanged CV
- Genuine interest in the specific role often isn't communicated, even when it's real

WHAT THIS MEANS

Anything on your CV is fair game in an interview. If you can't speak fluently to a line item, it shouldn't be there — polish without substance is easier to spot than ever, and it costs you trust the moment it's tested.

TRY THIS TODAY

Go through your CV line by line and remove or rewrite anything you couldn't comfortably discuss for two minutes unprompted.





Cork Airport

Head of HR

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“Employers don't hire the most qualified candidate — they hire the candidate who combines the required ability with the best attitude, communication and preparation.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- Outdated CVs that don't reflect a candidate's current situation are read as a lack of care
- Confirmed hires are regularly lost after the offer stage by not completing vetting steps on time
- Preparation is rare enough that it “sticks out in memory” when it happens

WHAT THIS MEANS

Once you clear the competence bar, attitude and visible preparation become the tiebreaker — and they're also the easiest things to actually control before you walk in.

TRY THIS TODAY

Prepare two specific, current facts about the employer you can naturally work into the conversation — and make sure your CV reflects your actual, current situation before you send it.





KPC International

Talent Acquisition Specialist, Pharmaceutical & Engineering Recruitment

RECRUITER INSIGHT

“A 90% match and a 74% match can honestly be the same quality of candidate — the score just doesn't know they described the skill differently.”

THE PATTERN THEY SEE

- A technology or certification is listed on the CV with no evidence of where or how it was actually used
- The requirement that actually matters gets buried inside a general years-of-experience total instead of standing out on its own
- Candidates use their own employer's internal job title instead of the industry-standard term, so directly relevant experience never gets recognised

WHAT THIS MEANS

A percentage match isn't the real test — evidence is. Recruiters are trying to work out whether you can actually do the essential parts of the job, using your own words mapped against theirs. A lower-looking match with clear, specific evidence beats a higher one with none behind it.

TRY THIS TODAY

Open the job spec and mark which requirements are essential versus preferred. For each essential one, add a single specific example from your own experience — even if you'd describe it differently — that proves you've actually done it.





YOU'VE READ THE RESEARCH. NOW APPLY IT.

Want us to apply this directly to your CV and LinkedIn?

This guide is the same research we use to reposition every client's real experience — the CVs, the LinkedIn profile, the cover letter. Nothing invented, everything reframed around what these eleven hiring leaders actually said.

[Get interview-ready →](#)

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